

START-UPS ASTROTECH

gemstones. Notably, most of these start-ups have already attained profitability, one of the reasons fueling investor interest. Platforms like Astrotalk and InstaAstro exemplify the sector's potential, particularly when scaling into international markets where profit margins are often much higher, Damani says.

Astrotalk, founder Gupta says, has been profitable since its inception in 2017 and claims that

vices—an impressive achievement in any industry.

CHARTING NEW PATHS

AstroSage is also coming up with its new product *Kundli* AI which will help people in learning astrology with the help of AI. Pandey claims that AstroSage has a 90% market share among astrologers.

Astrology requires a deep knowledge of ancient Hindu texts as well

among those aged 35 and above.

Ankush Kakkar, an astrologer, Vastu consultant, and founder of Om Kar Astro Research, says: "While technology and online consultations have surged in the last two to three years, offline consultations are still significant for many." Kakkar also agrees that younger individuals are opting for private online consultations rather than traditional family visits to astrologers.

Yet, Kakkar views AI as a support system for astrologers and not a replacement, enabling them to leverage technology to enhance productivity and analyse more *kundlis* within a given timeframe. He says that as technology evolves, so will astrotech. The progress does not mean the traditional appeal of meeting astrologers and receiving personalised insights will fade.

A generational shift is also reflected in the revenue trends of astrotech start-ups. Madaan and Astrotalk's Gupta note that online consultations, particularly from the younger demographic, are significant revenue drivers. Gupta adds that video call consultations account for less than 0.1% of revenue, underscoring privacy as a critical factor. Kapoor of AstroYogi says 35% of the app's traffic comes from users aged 18-35.

According to Mukesh Kumar, Associate Partner at RedSeer, India's astrology market has the potential to move towards an organised structure, offering significant opportunities for participants. This trend extends globally.

In India, the top three players by customer base are Astrotalk, AstroSage, and AstroYogi, with Astrotalk being the only funded company among them, says Kumar. When it comes to funding, Astrotalk, InstaAstro, Taaraka, Bodhi,



"What attracts us as investors is the customer satisfaction score and NPS when evaluating astrotech companies"

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the company expects to close the current financial year with a profit of ₹140 crore. The trajectory is noteworthy, considering the meteoric rise in revenue from ₹17 crore in FY20 to ₹659 crore in FY24. Profitability too leapt, from over ₹8 crore in FY23 to ₹100 crore in FY24—a nearly 13-fold jump in just one year, as per Tracxn data.

"We capture 80-85% of India's astrotech market," says Gupta with pride. Pandey says astrology apps are witnessing remarkable growth, with major platforms seeing revenue increases of 5-10% per month, driven by the high demand for personalised, on-demand ser-

as the ability to make fast and accurate calculations, says Dadha, and AI's accuracy will create platforms that offers both reliability and a deeper sense of connection to users.

The evolution underscores how technology, powered by AI and ML, is redefining astrology. Even so, the offline space continues to hold significance. Traditional astrologers and offline consultations still play a vital role, especially in regions where digital adoption is slower.

Astrology's digital evolution has transformed the way people seek guidance, and while astrotech is ripe for disruption, offline consultations still remain relevant, especially